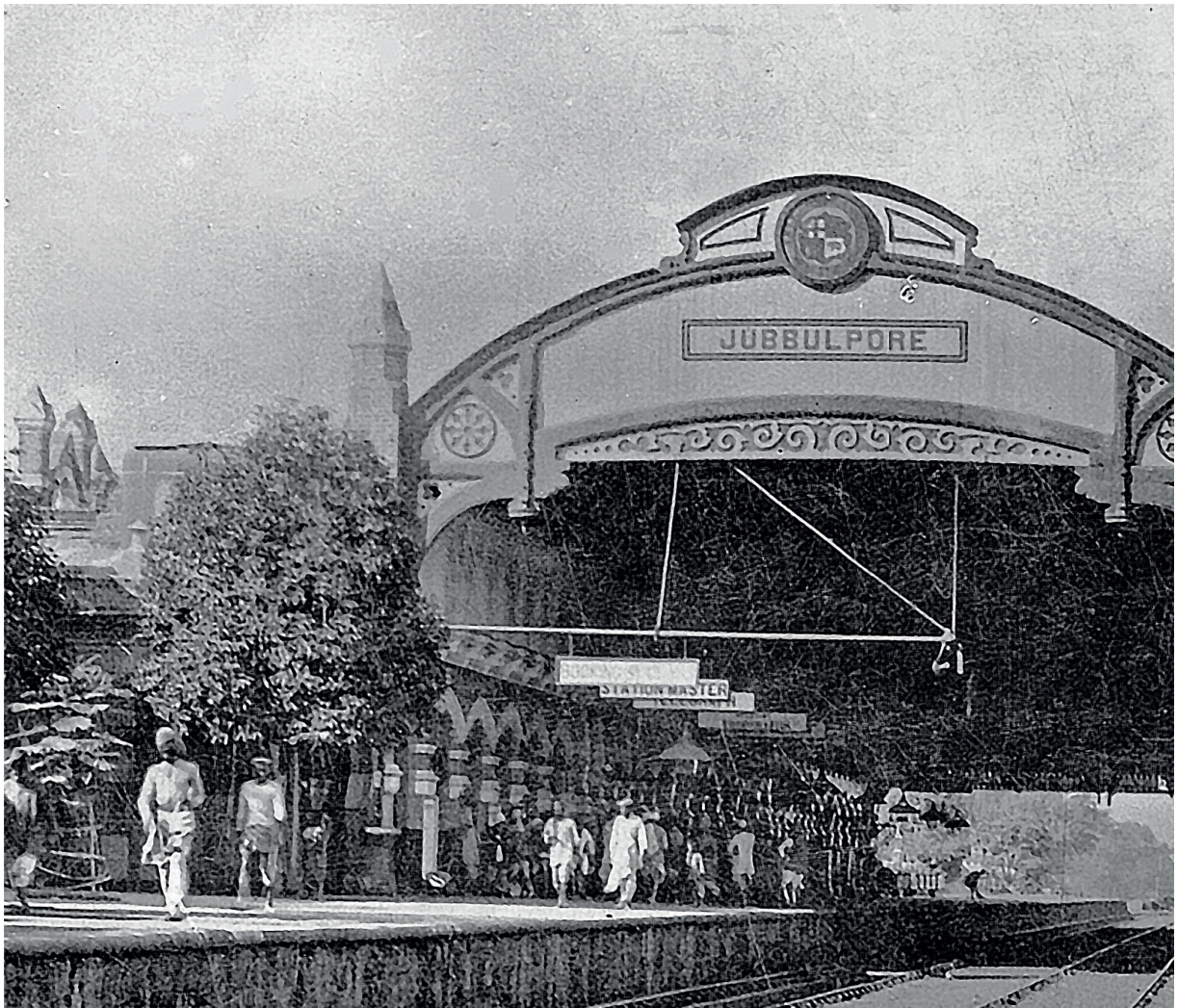




▲ **This archival image of the Jubbulpore station** shows the EIR emblem above the station's name. A major junction in the Indian Railways system today, modern-day Jabalpur station is a sprawling structure with lines to almost all major hubs in the country.

Jubbulpore (modern-day Jabalpur) is about 50 km from the point considered to be the geographical centre of India. Before its annexation by the British in 1817, Jubbulpore had long been ruled by the indigenous Gond kings of the land, and later by the Bhonsles, the Maratha clan from Nagpur. The traditional trade route from Nagpur (in modern-day Maharashtra), to Mirzapore (Mirzapur, in modern-day Uttar Pradesh), passed through Jubbulpore. That it would be a major junction in the route connecting east to west was quickly understood by both the Great Indian Peninsula Railway (GIPR) and East Indian Railway (EIR).